BRANDOPS

Student User Guide

P1 P2 P3 P4 P5 P6

Brand Name

Team Members

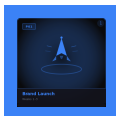
Industry

Semester

Every Week, Your Team Should:

- ☐ **Complete your phase deliverable** Your creative project — the core of each week
- ☐ **Respond to your Event Card** Your teacher applies stats based on your work quality
- ☐ **Post to BuzzNet x2** From your Brand Dashboard — post in your brand's voice
- ☐ **Write your Journal Entry** Reflect on the week's prompt from your Brand Dashboard
- ☐ **Check your Market Score** Watch the live leaderboard — it updates in real time

> BuzzNet is the simulation's live social feed — scroll on the class screen in real time. Post as your brand (max 2/week) using the BuzzNet tab on your Brand Dashboard. Your logo and brand color appear on every post automatically.



Phase 1 — Brand Launch

Weeks 1–3

Establish your brand identity and make your first impression. The choices you make here set the foundation for everything that follows.

WEEKLY CHECKLIST

WK	DELIVERABLE DUE	JOURNAL	BUZZNET	SHL LTR	☐
1	**Brand Strategy Document**	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
2	**Logo & Visual Identity**	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
3	**30-Second Launch Commercial**	☐	☐ ☐	☐ Due	☐

DELIVERABLES

☐ Brand Strategy Document

Reputation + · Demand +

A 1-page written document defining your brand's identity, market position, and strategic direction.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Target Market Analysis	Defines a specific, realistic target market with clear demographics, needs, and buying behavior, backed by evidence.	Identifies a target market with basic demographics, but detail or supporting reasoning is thin.	Target market is vague, generic (“everyone”), or missing.
Brand Positioning	Positions the brand in a distinct, defensible space with a clear reason customers would choose it.	States a positioning that is understandable but overlaps with competitors or lacks a sharp point of difference.	Positioning is unclear, contradictory, or absent.
Color Psychology	Color choices are deliberate and justified by the emotions and associations they create for the target audience.	Colors are chosen with some reasoning, but the psychological rationale is partial or loosely connected.	Colors appear random with no rationale tied to audience or mood.
Tone & Voice	A consistent, well-defined brand voice is established and clearly matched to the audience and market.	A recognizable tone is present but wavers or is only loosely tied to the audience.	Tone is inconsistent, generic, or undefined.
Competitive Differentiation	Clearly articulates what sets the brand apart from named competitors with convincing, specific reasoning.	Names a point of difference, but it is general or not strongly supported.	Little or no differentiation; the brand blends in with competitors.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			_____ / 25
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

☐ Logo & Visual Identity

Reputation + · Innovation +

A complete visual system: logo, color palette (HEX codes), typography pairings, and packaging mockup.

Vector format required — submit as .AI or .SVG. Created in Adobe Illustrator (on computers).

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Logo Design Quality	Logo is original, memorable, and professionally executed; works at any size and communicates the brand instantly.	Logo is clean and appropriate but ordinary, or has minor execution or scalability issues.	Logo is unfinished, derivative, or unclear about what the brand is.
Vector Craft	Delivered as clean vector art (.AI/.SVG) with precise paths, correct anchor points, and no raster artifacts.	Vector file is functional but has messy paths, stray points, or minor technical issues.	Not true vector, or contains major technical flaws (raster embedded, broken paths).
Color Palette	A cohesive palette with defined HEX codes and clear primary/secondary roles that reinforce the brand.	A workable palette is provided, but roles or HEX values are incomplete or the mix is slightly off.	Palette is missing, clashing, or has no defined values.
Typography	Type pairings are intentional, legible, and on-brand, with a clear hierarchy.	Type choices are acceptable but generic or with weak hierarchy.	Type is unreadable, mismatched, or unconsidered.
Packaging Mockup	Mockup is realistic and polished, showing the identity applied convincingly to real packaging.	Mockup shows the concept but is rough, flat, or only partially realized.	Mockup is missing or does not represent usable packaging.
System Cohesion	Logo, color, type, and packaging read as one unified, deliberate system.	Elements mostly work together but a piece or two feels disconnected.	Elements feel unrelated; no sense of a single brand system.
TOTAL (6 criteria × 5 = 30 pts max)			**_____ / 30**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

☐ 30-Second Launch Commercial

Demand + · Reputation +

A produced video advertisement introducing your brand to the world for the first time.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Concept & Message	A clear, original concept drives one focused message the audience will remember.	A concept and message are present but predictable or slightly unfocused.	No clear concept; the message is confusing or absent.
Target Demo Connection	Content is precisely tuned to the target demographic's interests, language, and platform.	Content generally fits the demographic but misses some cues.	Content ignores or misreads the target demographic.
Visual & Audio Production (Std 4.3)	Footage and sound are clean, well-lit, well-composed, and edited to a professional standard.	Production is watchable with acceptable audio/visual quality but noticeable rough spots.	Production quality undermines the message (poor audio, shaky/dark footage).
Pacing & Structure	Structure builds logically and pacing holds attention from open to close.	Structure is followable but drags, rushes, or feels uneven in places.	No clear structure; pacing loses the viewer.
Brand Identity Alignment	Every visual and message choice reinforces the established brand identity.	Mostly on-brand, with a few off-brand choices.	Contradicts or ignores the brand identity.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			**_____ / 25**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

☐ Elevator Pitch Presentation

Reputation + · Budget +

A live investor pitch presented to the class. Time limit: 2–3 minutes. No reading from notes.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Clarity of Value Proposition	The value proposition is stated sharply in one line an investor could repeat back.	Value proposition is present but wordy or partly unclear.	No clear value proposition; the pitch's point is lost.
Delivery & Confidence	Delivered with poise, eye contact, and energy; no reliance on notes.	Competent delivery with some hesitation or note-reliance.	Delivery is read verbatim, unclear, or visibly unprepared.
Competitive Differentiation	Clearly articulates what sets the brand apart from named competitors with convincing, specific reasoning.	Names a point of difference, but it is general or not strongly supported.	Little or no differentiation; the brand blends in with competitors.
Market Justification	Claims are backed with credible market reasoning and realistic numbers.	Some justification given, but reasoning or evidence is thin.	Assertions are unsupported or unrealistic.
Investor Q&A Response	Handles tough questions directly, confidently, and with substance.	Answers questions adequately but with gaps or uncertainty.	Cannot answer questions or deflects entirely.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			**_____ / 25**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

WEEKLY JOURNAL ENTRIES — 3 total (Weeks 1–3)

Week 1	Week 2	Week 3
☐ Submitted Grade: _____	☐ Submitted Grade: _____	☐ Submitted Grade: _____

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Responds to the Weekly Prompt	Fully and directly answers the week's prompt with clear focus.	Addresses the prompt but partially or with some drift.	Misses, ignores, or misreads the prompt.
Brand Decision Analysis	Analyzes the week's brand decisions with clear cause-and-effect reasoning and specific examples.	Describes decisions but analysis stays surface-level.	Lists events with no real analysis.
Depth of Reflection	Reflection is thoughtful and honest, showing genuine insight into what was learned.	Some reflection is present but stays general.	Little or no reflection; purely descriptive.
Writing Quality	Clear, well-organized, and virtually error-free writing with a professional tone.	Generally clear with some errors or organizational lapses.	Frequent errors or disorganization make it hard to follow.
TOTAL (4 criteria × 5 = 20 pts max)			**_____ / 20**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

SHAREHOLDER LETTER

A one-page CEO letter to shareholders reflecting on this phase's decisions and projecting forward into the next.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Honest Reflection on Decisions	Reflects candidly on real decisions, owning both wins and mistakes.	Reflects on decisions but softens or skims over shortcomings.	Avoids honest reflection or is purely self-congratulatory.
Acknowledgment of Challenges	Names specific challenges clearly and shows understanding of their impact.	Mentions challenges but vaguely or without much insight.	Ignores or denies any challenges.
Forward Strategy	Lays out a concrete, credible plan for the next phase tied to what was learned.	Offers a general direction forward without much specificity.	No forward strategy or an unrealistic one.
Brand Voice	Written consistently in a convincing, on-brand CEO voice throughout.	Mostly on-brand voice with some slips into generic tone.	Voice is inconsistent or absent.
Writing Quality	Clear, well-organized, and virtually error-free writing with a professional tone.	Generally clear with some errors or organizational lapses.	Frequent errors or disorganization make it hard to follow.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			**_____ / 25**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

Phase 2 — Market Pressure

Weeks 4–7

Crises hit, competitors emerge, and volatility increases. How you handle adversity defines your brand more than how you perform in calm conditions.

WEEKLY CHECKLIST

WK	DELIVERABLE DUE	JOURNAL	BUZZNET	SHL LTR	☐
4	**Crisis Response Commercial**	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
5	**Social Media Pivot Plan**	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
6	**Competitor SWOT Analysis**	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
7	—	☐	☐ ☐	☐ Due	☐

DELIVERABLES

☐ Crisis Response Commercial

Reputation + · Risk −

A 60-second produced video responding to the event card your team received this phase.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Directly Addresses the Crisis	Confronts the crisis head-on, naming it and responding without evasion.	Addresses the crisis but partially or indirectly.	Dodges, downplays, or ignores the crisis.
Authenticity of Tone	Tone reads as genuine and human, earning audience trust.	Tone is acceptable but feels somewhat scripted or generic.	Tone rings false, defensive, or tone-deaf.
Clear Path Forward	Offers a specific, believable path forward that reassures the audience.	Suggests a path forward but vaguely or incompletely.	No clear path forward is offered.
Brand Voice Consistency	Voice stays fully consistent with the established brand across the whole piece.	Voice is mostly consistent with occasional lapses.	Voice is inconsistent or off-brand.
Production Quality (Std 4.3)	Professional-level production: clean audio, strong visuals, polished edit.	Acceptable production with noticeable rough spots.	Production quality undermines the message.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			_____ / 25
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

☐ Social Media Pivot Plan

Demand + · Reputation +

A minimum of 3 produced BuzzNet posts redirecting the brand's narrative after the crisis.

At least one post must feature original photography — no stock imagery.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Strategic Narrative Shift	Clearly and convincingly repositions the brand's story for a new direction.	Attempts a narrative shift but it is partial or unconvincing.	No meaningful narrative shift is made.
Original Photography (Std 4.1–4.4)	Uses original, well-composed, well-lit photography that meets standard.	Original photography is present but with technical or compositional weaknesses.	Relies on stock imagery or photography is unusable.
Platform Appropriateness	Content is precisely formatted and toned for its target platform.	Content generally fits the platform but misses some conventions.	Content ignores platform format and norms.
Visual & Copy Quality (Std 6.3)	Visuals and copy are polished, on-brand, and mutually reinforcing.	Visuals and copy are adequate but uneven in quality.	Visuals or copy are weak enough to hurt the message.
Audience Re-engagement	Gives the audience a compelling reason to re-engage with the brand.	Makes some effort to re-engage but the hook is weak.	Does nothing to win the audience back.
Brand Voice	Written consistently in a convincing, on-brand CEO voice throughout.	Mostly on-brand voice with some slips into generic tone.	Voice is inconsistent or absent.
TOTAL (6 criteria × 5 = 30 pts max)			_____ / 30
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

☐ Competitor SWOT Analysis

Innovation + · Risk –

A structured analysis of your assigned competitor's Strengths, Weaknesses, and Opportunities

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Strengths — Depth & Specificity	Identifies genuine strengths with specific, well-supported detail.	Names strengths but generally or without much support.	Strengths are missing, vague, or inaccurate.
Weaknesses — Honesty & Insight	Honestly identifies real weaknesses with insight into their causes.	Names weaknesses but softens them or lacks insight.	Avoids or ignores real weaknesses.
Opportunities — Strategic Value	Surfaces realistic, high-value opportunities tied to the brand's position.	Lists opportunities but of limited relevance or value.	Opportunities are missing or unrealistic.
Threats — Credibility	Identifies credible, specific threats the brand actually faces.	Names threats but generic or loosely supported.	Threats are missing or implausible.
Strategic Conclusion	Synthesizes the analysis into a clear, actionable strategic conclusion.	Reaches a conclusion but it is general or weakly tied to the analysis.	No real conclusion or one disconnected from the analysis.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			_____ / 25
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

WEEKLY JOURNAL ENTRIES — 4 total (Weeks 4–7)

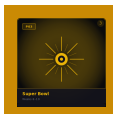
Week 4	Week 5	Week 6	Week 7
☐ Submitted Grade: _____	☐ Submitted Grade: _____	☐ Submitted Grade: _____	☐ Submitted Grade: _____

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Responds to the Weekly Prompt	Fully and directly answers the week's prompt with clear focus.	Addresses the prompt but partially or with some drift.	Misses, ignores, or misreads the prompt.
Brand Decision Analysis	Analyzes the week's brand decisions with clear cause-and-effect reasoning and specific examples.	Describes decisions but analysis stays surface-level.	Lists events with no real analysis.
Depth of Reflection	Reflection is thoughtful and honest, showing genuine insight into what was learned.	Some reflection is present but stays general.	Little or no reflection; purely descriptive.
Writing Quality	Clear, well-organized, and virtually error-free writing with a professional tone.	Generally clear with some errors or organizational lapses.	Frequent errors or disorganization make it hard to follow.
TOTAL (4 criteria × 5 = 20 pts max)			**_____ / 20**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

SHAREHOLDER LETTER

A one-page CEO letter to shareholders reflecting on this phase's decisions and projecting forward into the next.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Honest Reflection on Decisions	Reflects candidly on real decisions, owning both wins and mistakes.	Reflects on decisions but softens or skims over shortcomings.	Avoids honest reflection or is purely self-congratulatory.
Acknowledgment of Challenges	Names specific challenges clearly and shows understanding of their impact.	Mentions challenges but vaguely or without much insight.	Ignores or denies any challenges.
Forward Strategy	Lays out a concrete, credible plan for the next phase tied to what was learned.	Offers a general direction forward without much specificity.	No forward strategy or an unrealistic one.
Brand Voice	Written consistently in a convincing, on-brand CEO voice throughout.	Mostly on-brand voice with some slips into generic tone.	Voice is inconsistent or absent.
Writing Quality	Clear, well-organized, and virtually error-free writing with a professional tone.	Generally clear with some errors or organizational lapses.	Frequent errors or disorganization make it hard to follow.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			**_____ / 25**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**



Phase 3 — Super Bowl Campaign

Weeks 8–10

Super Bowl week. One commercial, 100 million people, one shot. Mass media demands emotional storytelling over product specs.

WEEKLY CHECKLIST

WK	DELIVERABLE DUE	JOURNAL	BUZZNET	SHL LTR	☐
8	**Super Bowl Commercial (60 Seconds)**	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
9	**Storyboard**	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
10	**15-Second Cutdown**	☐	☐ ☐	☐ Due	☐

DELIVERABLES

☐ Super Bowl Commercial (60 Seconds)

Demand + · Reputation + · Innovation +

A cinematic 60-second advertisement — the most-watched commercial slot of the season.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Cinematic Concept	A strong, original cinematic idea drives the whole piece.	A concept is present but conventional or loosely developed.	No clear cinematic concept.
Target Demo Connection	Content is precisely tuned to the target demographic's interests, language, and platform.	Content generally fits the demographic but misses some cues.	Content ignores or misreads the target demographic.
Production Quality (Std 4.1–4.3)	Professional production throughout: composition, lighting, sound, and edit.	Acceptable production with some noticeable weaknesses.	Production quality undermines the piece.
Storytelling Arc	A clear, engaging arc carries the viewer from beginning to end.	A basic arc is present but underdeveloped or uneven.	No discernible story arc.
Brand Identity Alignment	Every visual and message choice reinforces the established brand identity.	Mostly on-brand, with a few off-brand choices.	Contradicts or ignores the brand identity.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			_____ / 25
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

☐ Storyboard

Innovation + · Demand +

A minimum 12-frame visual plan for the Super Bowl commercial, with shot descriptions, dialogue/VO, and timing.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Completeness (12+ frames)	Meets or exceeds the 12-frame requirement with a full, coherent sequence.	Close to the requirement but a few frames short or incomplete.	Well under the requirement or largely incomplete.
Shot Descriptions	Each frame has clear, specific shot descriptions (angle, movement, action).	Descriptions are present but vague or inconsistent.	Descriptions are missing or unusable.
Visual Quality	Frames are clean, clear, and communicate the intended visual well.	Frames are legible but rough or inconsistent.	Frames are unclear or unusable.
Timing & Pacing	Timing notes create a clear, effective sense of pacing across the sequence.	Timing is indicated but uneven or incomplete.	No usable timing or pacing information.
Connection to Final Film	Clearly maps to and sets up the intended final film.	Connects to the final film loosely or partially.	No clear connection to the final film.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			**_____ / 25**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

☐ 15-Second Cutdown

Demand + · Innovation +

A standalone 15-second version of the Super Bowl commercial that works independently.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Standalone Coherence	The cut stands on its own as a clear, complete piece.	Mostly coherent but with confusing or loose moments.	Does not hold together as a standalone piece.
Editorial Decisions	Cuts, order, and transitions are deliberate and strengthen the piece.	Editing choices are functional but unremarkable or occasionally awkward.	Editing choices are careless or hurt the piece.
Brand Message Retention	The brand message survives the edit fully intact and clear.	Brand message mostly survives but is somewhat diluted.	Brand message is lost in the edit.
Pacing & Energy	Pacing keeps energy high and holds attention throughout.	Pacing is acceptable but sags or rushes in places.	Pacing kills the energy or loses the viewer.
Ending / Final Frame	Ends on a strong, memorable, on-brand final frame.	Ending is adequate but flat or generic.	Ending is weak, abrupt, or missing.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			**_____ / 25**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

WEEKLY JOURNAL ENTRIES — 3 total (Weeks 8–10)

Week 8	Week 9	Week 10
☐ Submitted Grade: _____	☐ Submitted Grade: _____	☐ Submitted Grade: _____

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Responds to the Weekly Prompt	Fully and directly answers the week's prompt with clear focus.	Addresses the prompt but partially or with some drift.	Misses, ignores, or misreads the prompt.
Brand Decision Analysis	Analyzes the week's brand decisions with clear cause-and-effect reasoning and specific examples.	Describes decisions but analysis stays surface-level.	Lists events with no real analysis.
Depth of Reflection	Reflection is thoughtful and honest, showing genuine insight into what was learned.	Some reflection is present but stays general.	Little or no reflection; purely descriptive.
Writing Quality	Clear, well-organized, and virtually error-free writing with a professional tone.	Generally clear with some errors or organizational lapses.	Frequent errors or disorganization make it hard to follow.
TOTAL (4 criteria × 5 = 20 pts max)			**_____ / 20**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

SHAREHOLDER LETTER

A one-page CEO letter to shareholders reflecting on this phase's decisions and projecting forward into the next.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Honest Reflection on Decisions	Reflects candidly on real decisions, owning both wins and mistakes.	Reflects on decisions but softens or skims over shortcomings.	Avoids honest reflection or is purely self-congratulatory.
Acknowledgment of Challenges	Names specific challenges clearly and shows understanding of their impact.	Mentions challenges but vaguely or without much insight.	Ignores or denies any challenges.
Forward Strategy	Lays out a concrete, credible plan for the next phase tied to what was learned.	Offers a general direction forward without much specificity.	No forward strategy or an unrealistic one.
Brand Voice	Written consistently in a convincing, on-brand CEO voice throughout.	Mostly on-brand voice with some slips into generic tone.	Voice is inconsistent or absent.
Writing Quality	Clear, well-organized, and virtually error-free writing with a professional tone.	Generally clear with some errors or organizational lapses.	Frequent errors or disorganization make it hard to follow.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			**_____ / 25**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

Phase 4 — Product Placement

Weeks 11–13

Product placement. Your brand must become part of the story — not an interruption to it. The invisible sell is the hardest one.

WEEKLY CHECKLIST

WK	DELIVERABLE DUE	JOURNAL	BUZZNET	SHL LTR	☐
11	**Product Placement Scene**	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
12	—	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
13	—	☐	☐ ☐	☐ **Due**	☐

DELIVERABLES

☐ Product Placement Scene

Innovation + · Demand + · Reputation +

A scripted 2–3 minute film scene with your product naturally integrated — not advertised, but present.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Script & Scene Quality	Script and scenes are well-written, believable, and purposeful.	Script and scenes work but feel thin or uneven.	Script or scenes are weak enough to undermine the piece.
Natural Integration	The brand is woven in naturally so it never feels forced.	Integration is mostly natural with a few forced moments.	Integration feels forced, obvious, or jarring.
Brand Authenticity	The brand feels authentic and true to its established identity.	Brand is mostly authentic with minor off notes.	Brand feels inauthentic or off-identity.
Production Quality (Std 4.1–4.3)	Professional production throughout: composition, lighting, sound, and edit.	Acceptable production with some noticeable weaknesses.	Production quality undermines the piece.
Audience Belief	The audience would fully believe and buy into the piece.	The audience would mostly buy in, with some doubt.	The audience would not believe or engage.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			_____ / 25
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

WEEKLY JOURNAL ENTRIES — 3 total (Weeks 11–13)

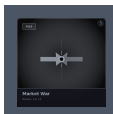
Week 11	Week 12	Week 13
☐ Submitted Grade: _____	☐ Submitted Grade: _____	☐ Submitted Grade: _____

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Responds to the Weekly Prompt	Fully and directly answers the week's prompt with clear focus.	Addresses the prompt but partially or with some drift.	Misses, ignores, or misreads the prompt.
Brand Decision Analysis	Analyzes the week's brand decisions with clear cause-and-effect reasoning and specific examples.	Describes decisions but analysis stays surface-level.	Lists events with no real analysis.
Depth of Reflection	Reflection is thoughtful and honest, showing genuine insight into what was learned.	Some reflection is present but stays general.	Little or no reflection; purely descriptive.
Writing Quality	Clear, well-organized, and virtually error-free writing with a professional tone.	Generally clear with some errors or organizational lapses.	Frequent errors or disorganization make it hard to follow.
TOTAL (4 criteria × 5 = 20 pts max)			**_____ / 20**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

SHAREHOLDER LETTER

A one-page CEO letter to shareholders reflecting on this phase's decisions and projecting forward into the next.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Honest Reflection on Decisions	Reflects candidly on real decisions, owning both wins and mistakes.	Reflects on decisions but softens or skims over shortcomings.	Avoids honest reflection or is purely self-congratulatory.
Acknowledgment of Challenges	Names specific challenges clearly and shows understanding of their impact.	Mentions challenges but vaguely or without much insight.	Ignores or denies any challenges.
Forward Strategy	Lays out a concrete, credible plan for the next phase tied to what was learned.	Offers a general direction forward without much specificity.	No forward strategy or an unrealistic one.
Brand Voice	Written consistently in a convincing, on-brand CEO voice throughout.	Mostly on-brand voice with some slips into generic tone.	Voice is inconsistent or absent.
Writing Quality	Clear, well-organized, and virtually error-free writing with a professional tone.	Generally clear with some errors or organizational lapses.	Frequent errors or disorganization make it hard to follow.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			**_____ / 25**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**



Phase 5 — Market War

Weeks 14–15

Market War. The gloves are off. Comparative advertising is now on the table — use it wisely.

WEEKLY CHECKLIST

WK	DELIVERABLE DUE	JOURNAL	BUZZNET	SHL LTR	☐
14	**Market War Campaign**	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
15	—	☐	☐ ☐	☐ **Due**	☐

DELIVERABLES

☐ Market War Campaign — Demand + · Risk

A comparative ad, satirical campaign, or direct challenge targeting your assigned competitor.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Clarity of Attack Strategy	A clear, focused competitive attack strategy is defined and easy to follow.	A strategy is present but fuzzy or only partly focused.	No clear attack strategy.
Competitor Research (Std 7.1)	Backed by specific, credible competitor research meeting standard.	Some competitor research is present but shallow.	Little or no competitor research.
Creative Execution	Execution is original, sharp, and effectively delivers the strategy.	Execution is competent but predictable.	Execution is weak or off-strategy.
Risk Management	Anticipates and addresses the risks of the strategy thoughtfully.	Acknowledges risk but with limited planning.	Ignores risk entirely.
Production & Presentation	Polished production and confident presentation throughout.	Acceptable production and presentation with rough spots.	Production or presentation undermines the work.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			_____ / 25
GAME SCORE			1 · 3 · 5

WEEKLY JOURNAL ENTRIES — 2 total (Weeks 14–15)

Week 14	Week 15
☐ Submitted Grade: _____	☐ Submitted Grade: _____

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Responds to the Weekly Prompt	Fully and directly answers the week's prompt with clear focus.	Addresses the prompt but partially or with some drift.	Misses, ignores, or misreads the prompt.
Brand Decision Analysis	Analyzes the week's brand decisions with clear cause-and-effect reasoning and specific examples.	Describes decisions but analysis stays surface-level.	Lists events with no real analysis.
Depth of Reflection	Reflection is thoughtful and honest, showing genuine insight into what was learned.	Some reflection is present but stays general.	Little or no reflection; purely descriptive.
Writing Quality	Clear, well-organized, and virtually error-free writing with a professional tone.	Generally clear with some errors or organizational lapses.	Frequent errors or disorganization make it hard to follow.
TOTAL (4 criteria × 5 = 20 pts max)			**_____ / 20**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

SHAREHOLDER LETTER

A one-page CEO letter to shareholders reflecting on this phase's decisions and projecting forward into the next.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Honest Reflection on Decisions	Reflects candidly on real decisions, owning both wins and mistakes.	Reflects on decisions but softens or skims over shortcomings.	Avoids honest reflection or is purely self-congratulatory.
Acknowledgment of Challenges	Names specific challenges clearly and shows understanding of their impact.	Mentions challenges but vaguely or without much insight.	Ignores or denies any challenges.
Forward Strategy	Lays out a concrete, credible plan for the next phase tied to what was learned.	Offers a general direction forward without much specificity.	No forward strategy or an unrealistic one.
Brand Voice	Written consistently in a convincing, on-brand CEO voice throughout.	Mostly on-brand voice with some slips into generic tone.	Voice is inconsistent or absent.
Writing Quality	Clear, well-organized, and virtually error-free writing with a professional tone.	Generally clear with some errors or organizational lapses.	Frequent errors or disorganization make it hard to follow.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			**_____ / 25**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

Phase 6 — Rebrand or Die

Weeks 16–18

A terminal event has hit your brand. The identity you built is now a liability. Rebuild from scratch. Make the case for a second chapter.

WEEKLY CHECKLIST

WK	DELIVERABLE DUE	JOURNAL	BUZZNET	SHL LTR	☐
16	**Rebrand Logo**	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
17	**Investor Pitch Deck**	☐	☐ ☐	—	☐
18	—	☐	☐ ☐	☐ **Due**	☐

DELIVERABLES

☐ Rebrand Logo

Reputation + · Innovation +

A new logo signaling the brand's transformation following the Phase 6 crisis event.

▶️ *Vector format required — submit as .AI or .SVG. Created in Adobe Illustrator or Affinity Designer.*

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Signals Meaningful Change	The rebrand clearly signals a real, intentional change in the brand.	Signals some change but it is subtle or unclear.	Signals no meaningful change.
Retains Brand Equity	Evolves the brand while keeping the equity that made it recognizable.	Keeps some equity but risks losing recognition.	Discards brand equity; the brand becomes unrecognizable.
Vector Craft (Std 5.1)	Delivered as clean vector art (.AI/.SVG) with precise paths, correct anchor points, and no raster artifacts.	Vector file is functional but has messy paths, stray points, or minor technical issues.	Not true vector, or contains major technical flaws (raster embedded, broken paths).
Design Quality	Design work is polished, professional, and on-brand.	Design is acceptable but uneven or ordinary.	Design quality is poor.
Justification Narrative	A convincing narrative clearly justifies the rebrand decisions.	Justification is present but thin or partly persuasive.	No real justification for the rebrand.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			**_____ / 25**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

☐ Investor Pitch Deck

Budget + · Reputation + · Demand +

A full presentation synthesizing the brand's season history, rebrand rationale, and financial case for reinvestment.

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Season Narrative Arc	Tells a clear, compelling story of the brand's journey across the season.	A season arc is present but uneven or underdeveloped.	No coherent season arc.
Rebrand Rationale	Rationale for the rebrand is specific, evidence-based, and convincing.	Rationale is present but general or weakly supported.	Rationale is missing or unconvincing.
Market & Financial Case	Makes a credible market and financial case with realistic figures.	Some market/financial reasoning, but thin or partly unrealistic.	No credible market or financial case.
Visual Presentation Design (Std 6.1)	Slides/visuals are clean, professional, and reinforce the message (meets standard).	Visual design is acceptable but uneven or cluttered.	Visual design is poor enough to distract.
Presentation Delivery	Delivered with confidence, clarity, and command of the material.	Competent delivery with some hesitation or unevenness.	Delivery is unprepared, unclear, or read verbatim.
TOTAL (5 criteria × 5 = 25 pts max)			**_____ / 25**
GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

WEEKLY JOURNAL ENTRIES — 3 total (Weeks 16–18)

Week 16	Week 17	Week 18
☐ Submitted	☐ Submitted	☐ Submitted
Grade: _____	Grade: _____	Grade: _____

CRITERION	ADVANCED (5)	PROFICIENT (3)	BELOW BASIC (1)
Responds to the Weekly Prompt	Fully and directly answers the week's prompt with clear focus.	Addresses the prompt but partially or with some drift.	Misses, ignores, or misreads the prompt.
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GAME SCORE			**1 · 3 · 5**

SHAREHOLDER LETTER

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QUICK REFERENCE

✓ HELPS YOUR BRAND	✗ HURTS YOUR BRAND
✓ Score Advanced (5) on deliverables	✗ Score Below Basic (1) on deliverables
✓ Choose smart event responses	✗ Ignore event consequences
✓ Stay consistent with your brand identity	✗ Let Risk build up without responding
✓ Keep Risk low with proactive decisions	✗ Make choices that contradict your brand
✓ Justify your creative choices clearly	✗ Miss deliverables entirely
✓ Post to BuzzNet consistently (2x/week)	✗ Submit logos as raster files (must be .AI/.SVG)
✓ Set your logo, tagline & brand color early	✗ Use stock photos for social deliverables

The Golden Rule

Your creative work IS your gameplay. Every poster, commercial, pitch, and campaign you produce gets translated into real stat changes. The better the work, the stronger your brand. There are no shortcuts.

GLOSSARY

Market Score	Brand strength calculated from all five stats. Used to rank teams on the leaderboard.
Stock Price	Dollar value reflecting your Market Score plus small random market drift.
Volatility	0–100 setting controlling how extreme event effects are and how often Wildcards appear.
Brand Dossier	Your team's fixed brand profile — industry, country, demographic, components, price point.
Brand Identity	Your logo, tagline, and brand color. Set from your Brand Dashboard.
Event Card	A real-world scenario drawn by the teacher that changes your stats.
Choice Event	An event card with two options (A/B). Your teacher picks based on your deliverable that week.
Deliverable	Your actual creative project for the week — a commercial, logo, pitch, etc.
BuzzNet	The simulation's live social feed. You get 2 brand posts per week from your Brand Dashboard.
Journal Entry	A weekly reflection prompt tied to that week's events. Found in your Brand Dashboard.
Shareholder Letter	A formal investor memo written at the end of each phase.
Brand Dashboard	Your personal student view — shows all stats, tabs, and BuzzNet composer.
Crisis Mode	Triggered when Risk hits 100 or Budget hits 0. A mandatory bad event fires automatically.